

TICKET TO BIG BUCKS

New generation managers want better growth prospects, international networks and robust salary packages—a dream few schools are equipped to fulfill

■ By Shruti Maheshwari

The MBA degree has emerged as the new benchmark for academic programmes across the country. People from all backgrounds, be it academic or professional, are heading to one B-school or another to realise that eternal dream—euphemistically called fast-track career progression or mid-career shift, which results in robust salary packages.

Whatever be the reasons, there seems to be a set of enviable deliverables waiting at the end of tunnel. Deliverance from dormancy, a salary graph that resembles the trajectory of an astronomical satellite, enhanced career prospects and so on. The magical journey lasts two years or just one year. MBA aspirants, claim B-school officials and academics, are wisening up. What's this fuss about salaries? It's holistic growth and development that they are after.

Professor Saral Mukherjee, placements in-charge at IIM-Ahmedabad, denies that most of IIM-A students, including executive MBA students, are driven by salaries and placements. "These stu-

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